

Christopher A. Lowenstein

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CURRENT	Postdoctoral Fellow University of Missouri - Columbia, Department of Economics <i>Faculty advisor:</i> Michael Pesko, PhD	Aug 2025 - present
RESEARCH AREAS	population health economics; health policy; labor economics; social epidemiology; health disparities	
EDUCATION	PhD, Health Policy (Health Economics track) University of California, Berkeley	2017–2022
	MPH, Epidemiology and Biostatistics University of California, Berkeley	2015–2017
	BA, Mathematical Economics, <i>magna cum laude</i> Colorado College	2008–2012
PUBLICATIONS	Landini, A., Lowenstein, C., and Pesko, M.F. (2026). Patterns of specialty tobacco retail locations and visitor counts in the USA. <i>Tobacco Control</i>, online ahead of print: doi:10.1136/tc-2026-060085 Lowenstein, C., Kamdar, N., & Rehkopf, D.H. (2026). Trends in Youth Mental Health Among Patients in Family Medicine Practices: 2017-2023. <i>Pediatrics</i>, 157(5), e2025072305. Weiss, D., Lowenstein, C., Sund, E., Vethe, D., & Krokstad, S. (2024). Diverging mental health trends in the post-pandemic era: results from the HUNT study, Norway. <i>Journal of Epidemiology & Community Health</i>, 79(3), 165-168. Lowenstein, C. (2024). “Deaths of despair” over the business cycle: New estimates from a shift-share instrumental variables approach. <i>Economics & Human Biology</i>, 53, 101374. Innstrand, S. T., Banks, C., Maslach, C., & Lowenstein, C. (2023) Healthy Universities: Exploring the Relationship between Psychosocial Needs and Work-Related Health Among University Employees. <i>Journal of Workplace Behavioral Health</i>, 38(2), 103-126. Dow, W. H., Godøy, A., Lowenstein, C., & Reich, M. (2020). Can Labor Market Policies Reduce Deaths of Despair?. <i>Journal of Health Economics</i>, 74, 102372. White, J. S., Lowenstein, C., Srivirojana, N., Jampaklay, A., & Dow, W. H. (2020). Incentive-based interventions for smoking cessation: A cluster randomized controlled trial in workplaces in Thailand. <i>BMJ</i> 371. Lowenstein, C., Dow, W. H., & White, J. S. (2020). Peer effects in smoking cessation: An instrumental variables analysis of a worksite intervention in Thailand. <i>SSM-Population Health</i>, 12, 100659. Lowenstein, C., Vasco, K., Sarzosa, S., Salinas, L., Mosco, A. T., ... & Graham, J. P. (2020). Determinants of Childhood Zoonotic Enteric Infections in a Semirural Com-	

munity of Quito, Ecuador. *The American Journal of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene*. 102(6), 1269.

Lowenstein, C., Waters, W. F., Roess, A., Leibler, J. H., & Graham, J. P. (2016). Animal husbandry practices and perceptions of zoonotic infectious disease risks among livestock keepers in a rural parish of Quito, Ecuador. *The American journal of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene*, 95(6), 1450-1458.

UNDER REVIEW

Lowenstein, C., Rong, M., & Rehkopf, D. H. (2026). Effects of the 2015 California EITC Expansion on Colorectal Cancer Risk Factors. Working paper available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=4931575>. *Revisions requested*.

Weiss, D., **Lowenstein, C.**, Sund, E., Vethe, D., & Krokstad, S. (2026). Flattening the social inequalities curve? A prospective, longitudinal analysis investigating COVID-19 pandemic gradients in mental health from the HUNT Study, Norway. *Revisions requested*.

Lowenstein, C., Hartmann-Boyce, J., & Pesko, M.F. (2026). Synthesizing Reduced Form Estimates from Heterogeneous Policy Instruments: Evidence from E-Cigarette Regulation. *Under review*.

SELECTED WORKING PAPERS

Venkataramani, A., O'Brien, R., Bair, E.F. & **Lowenstein, C.** (2025). Political Power and Mortality: Heterogeneous Effects of the U.S. Voting Rights Act. NBER Working Paper N. 34421. <http://www.nber.org/papers/w34421>.

Lowenstein, C., Godøy, A., Reich, M., Morin, P., Henk, H., & Dow, W. (2022). Do county-level employment changes affect the demand for prescription opioids? Evidence from a sample of commercially insured adults. Available at SSRN: <https://papers.ssrn.com/abstract=4940683>.

SELECTED RESEARCH REPORTS

Woolf, S. H., Aron L., Chapman, D. A., Dubay, L., Zimmerman, E., Snellings, L. C., Hall, L., Haley, A. D., Holla, N., Ayers, K., **Lowenstein, C.**, & Waidmann, T. A. (2016) The Health of the States Summary Report: How US States Compare in Health Status and the Factors that Shape Health. Washington, DC: The Urban Institute.

Simms, M., McDaniel, M., Fyffe, S. D., & **Lowenstein, C.** (2015). Structural Barriers to Racial Equity in Pittsburgh: Expanding Economic Opportunity for African American Men and Boys. Washington, DC: The Urban Institute.

Mills, G. B. & **C. Lowenstein**. (2015). Assessing the Merits of Photo EBT Cards in the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP). Washington, DC: The Urban Institute.

Turner, M. A., Edelman, P., Poethig, E. C., Aron, L. Y., Rogers, M., & **Lowenstein, C.** (2014). Tacking Persistent Poverty in Distressed Urban Neighborhoods. Washington, DC: The Urban Institute.

Edelstein, S., & **Lowenstein, C.** (2014). Characteristics and Impacts of Programs for Youth Transitioning out of Foster Care, Issue Brief 2: Financial Literacy and Asset Building Programs. OPRE Report No. 2014-69. Washington, DC: Administration for Children and Families, US Department of Health and Human Services.

Edelstein, S., & **Lowenstein, C.** (2014). Characteristics and Impacts of Programs for Youth Transitioning out of Foster Care, Issue Brief 3: Employment. OPRE Report No. 2014-70. Washington, DC: Administration for Children and Families, US Department of Health and Human Services.

Lowenstein, C., Golden, O., Emam, E., & McDaniel, M. (2013). Linking Depressed Mothers to Effective Services and Supports: A Policy and Systems Agenda for Improving Children’s Development and Preventing Child Abuse and Neglect. Washington, DC: The Urban Institute.

McDaniel, M., & **Lowenstein, C.** (2013). Depression in Low-Income Mothers of Young Children: Are they getting the treatment they need? Washington, DC: The Urban Institute.

COMMENTARY Dow, W. H., Godøy, A., **Lowenstein, C.**, Reich, M. A way out from rock bottom: Economic policies can reduce deaths of despair. VOX CEPR Policy Portal (July 7, 2019)

Lowenstein, Christopher. “Adding photos to food stamp cards would not reduce benefit trafficking.” Posted to Urban Institute’s Urban Wire on March 26, 2015.

Lowenstein, Christopher. “Major Gaps In Treatment for Low-Income Mothers with Depression Put Kids at Risk.” Posted to Urban Institute’s Urban Wire on April 17, 2013.

RESEARCH POSITIONS	Postdoctoral Scholar 2022–2025 Department of Epidemiology and Population Health Stanford University School of Medicine <i>Faculty advisor:</i> David Rehkopf, ScD, MPH
	Graduate Student Researcher 2018–2022 Institute for Research on Labor and Employment University of California, Berkeley (Berkeley, CA)
	Graduate Student Researcher 2015–2017 Interdisciplinary Center for Healthy Workplaces University of California, Berkeley (Berkeley, CA)
	Research Assistant/Research Associate II 2012–2015 Center on Labor, Human Services, and Population The Urban Institute (Washington, DC)
FUNDING AND AWARDS	Rapid Response Research Award 2025 Family Policy to Reduce Racial Inequalities in Health Research Hub University of California, Berkeley
	Ethics, Society, and Technology Rolling Grant 2023 McCoy Family Center for Ethics in Society, Stanford University (with Xuechao Qian and Mathew Kiang)
	Dissertation Fellowship 2021 Institute for Research on Labor and Employment, UC Berkeley
	Graduate Student Researcher Award 2020 Institute for Research on Labor and Employment, UC Berkeley
	NIH/NIAAA T32 Predoctoral Fellowship 2020–2021 <i>Graduate Research Training in Alcohol-Related Disparities</i> Alcohol Research Group (Emeryville, CA)
	NIH/NICHHD T32 Predoctoral Fellowship 2017–2019

Interdisciplinary Training in Demography
Department of Demography, UC Berkeley

David Hoskinson Graduate Scholarship 2017–2018
UC Berkeley School of Public Health

Block Grant Fellowship 2016–2017
UC Berkeley School of Public Health

Public Health Alumni Association Scholarship 2016–2017
UC Berkeley School of Public Health

TEACHING & MENTORING **Stanford Advancing Health Equity and Diversity (AHEaD)** Summer 2024
Near peer mentor and project lead

UC Berkeley Data Discovery Program Fall 2023/2024
Project lead for undergraduate data discovery project

Health Economics (Masters level) Fall 2019
Graduate Student Instructor for Professor Brent Fulton
UC Berkeley School of Public Health

Economic Demography (Undergraduate level) Spring 2019
Graduate Student Instructor for Professor Joshua Goldstein
UC Berkeley Department of Demography

CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION **Presentations:** American Society of Health Economists Annual Conference (2025, 2023, 2021^{*}); Population Association of America Annual Meeting (2025[†], 2023[†], 2021^{*}, 2020^{*}, 2018[†]); Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Fall Research Conference (2024, 2023); CAPS-CPR Conference on State Policies, Population Health (conference fellow, 2024); Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Student Seminal Series (2021^{*}); Interdisciplinary Association for Population Health Science (2022[†], 2021^{*}); International Health Economics Association Annual Congress (2021^{*}); AcademyHealth (2021^{*}); Society for Epidemiologic Research (2021^{*}).

Discussant: American Society of Health Economists (2025, 2024; Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Fall Research Conference (2023, 2022, 2021).

Leadership and service: American Society of Health Economist (2024, panel organizer/chair; panel chair); Population Association of America (2022, panel chair).

^{*} denotes virtual due to COVID-19

[†] denotes poster presentation

SERVICE **Peer review:** *Journal of Health Economics, Demography, Journal of Demographic Economics, International Journal of Health Economics and Management, Journal of Regional Science, Social Science and Medicine - Population Health, Social Science and Medicine - Mental Health, BMJ-Public Health, International Journal of Mental Health Promotion, Journal of Gerontological Social Work, Journal of Applied Life Sciences and Environment, Tobacco Induced Diseases*

Conference abstract review: 2026 ASHEcon Program Chair (Health, Labor Markets, and the Economy program area), IAPHS Abstract Review Committee (2022), ASHEcon Scientific Review Committee (2022, 2023)

Grant review: US-Israel Binational Science Foundation (2023)

Service and volunteer: Co-instructor and tutor, Mount Tamalpais College at San

Quentin State Prison (2020-current); Ambassador, UC Berkeley Graduate Recruitment and Diversity Services (GRADS) Program (2020-2021); Member, UC Berkeley Health Policy Admissions Committee (2020-2021)